

CAMERA PHONES

Panasonic X70

Price: Rs 17,000 **B-**

Designed with an eye for detail, the Panasonic X70 looks more like a piece of jewellery than a phone.

Priced at Rs 17,000, it's a good buy. It's competition for the equally well-balanced SE-Z600, which costs the same and offers the same features.

Although its dimensions don't really make it compact, the phone is sleek and comfortable to hold.

The external black and white LCD is long, and displays time in analogue and digital formats in idle mode. The TFT display is large and bright. The keys are of transparent smoked plastic with white legends etched on—all this illuminated by a white backlight. The keys are a little too flat, though—they should be raised a little for comfortable typing. A recessed four-directional jog-dial makes for easy menu browsing.

The grouping of functions in the menu is counter-intuitive. As an example, the Bluetooth settings were in some odd menu, and we had to browse through a whole bunch of sub-menus to find it.

The integrated camera comes with a photo-light that doubles up as a torch. Camera resolution is severely limited, though, and the snaps were no bigger than standard thumbnails in Windows XP.

The X70 comes with infrared and Bluetooth. Other salient features include tri-band compatibility and voice recording. However, this phone does not support Java applications.

The games provided are superb, especially *Skater*, which will keep you engrossed for hours.



Alcatel OneTouch 735

Price: Rs 9,995 **A**

The OneTouch 735 is priced at Rs 9,995, which is good given its feature set: Java support, WAP, GPRS and infrared, and a camera.

The brushed metal front with the chrome plated edge gives it a zingy look that should appeal to the younger generation.

The keys feel a little hard on the fingers, and because of the narrower lower body, the keys are small, too.

Menu navigation is via a joystick-key in the middle. This makes for very easy handling, as one button performs most of the navigation tasks. The key implementation is further complemented by a Windows-like menu approach—its main sections are arranged horizontally and the sub-sections vertically.

You can switch from standard menu icons to the 'mosaic' style,

where all icons are displayed in a single window.

SMSing is fast and accurate, and predictive typing is good. The only problem is the small keys, which makes the typing tiresome.

The phonebook has predefined folders such as personal, general, etc, which let you save contacts accordingly. You can assign a melody to a directory, or an image to a contact. However, if a contact is stored on the SIM, you can't assign an image to it. Voice recognition, too, will not work with contacts on the SIM.

The phone has a great game feature—once you get into Game mode, the screen changes from portrait to landscape mode. The camera is decent. The screen however, is just a 4K colour screen.

The One Touch 735 can be connected to a PC via infrared, for which the PC Software Suite is provided. But strangely enough, there's no data cable bundled, so we couldn't transfer data from or sync the phone with a PC.



Philips 535

Price: Rs 11,360 **A-**

Priced sensibly at Rs 11,360, the 535 integrates the Philips sound system. A successor to the 530 mobile phone, the new 535 comes with some additional frills. The design is unusual, so you'll like the phone if you want to break free of the Nokia and Sony Ericsson mould.

The model we reviewed was finished in deep scarlet with matte silver touches. It has a unisex appeal.

Its keypad is reasonably good. The keys offer the right tactile feedback, and the joystick is fun to use, though at times it gets a bit jittery and jumps to the wrong menu. Dedicated buttons make life easy when browsing the menu.

Its small 128 x 128 screen looks quite blurry, too. In daylight, the screen goes pale, but is still readable.

The 535 comes with an integrated VGA camera supporting a maximum resolution of 640 x 480 and a minimum of 128 x 128. Images are saved as JPEGs. The settings offered are colour modes, quality, resolutions and night shots. Images don't look that great on the phone's screen. They looked much better when they were trans-

